OCAN OREGON COMMUNITY ASYLUM NETWORK
Solidarity • Support • Advocacy Because No One Is Illegal

VOLUME 11, No. 3 NOVEMBER 2026

OUR MISSION

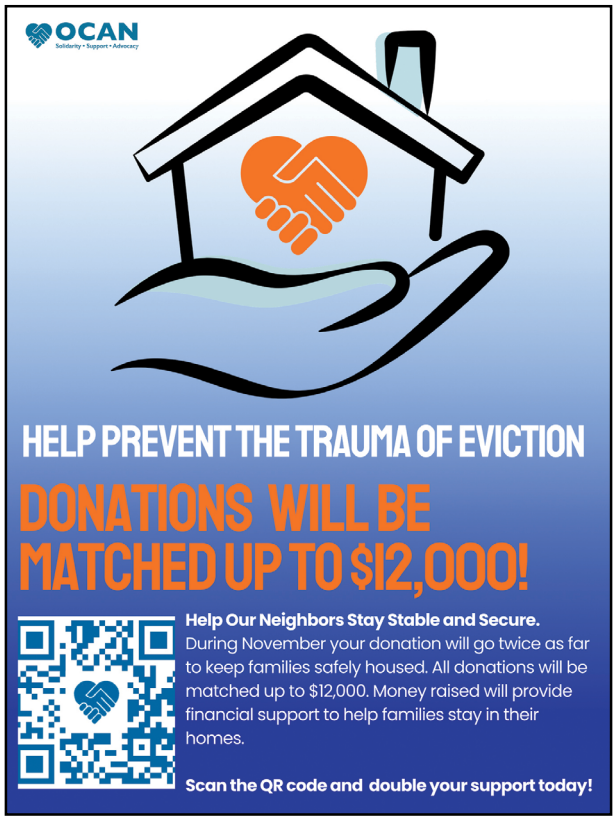
To assist and advocate for people in Lane County seeking safe haven in the United States through grassroots organizing, education, and sponsorship.

It's November! Our $25,000 Matching Campaign Has Started!

Our $12,000 matching donation campaign has started!
Please donate today and help OCAN reach our goal of $24,000 by Nov. 30th!

Do you wonder where your donation goes? Here is just one example:

A Lane County family is currently in crisis. The dad is being held in ICE detention in Tacoma, WA. The mom was released from house arrest but is barred from working, leaving her and her four children, along with a newborn grandchild, with no income and no end in sight.



In all our years of supporting immigrant families in Lane County, this is one of the cruelest situations we've seen—a household with five children deliberately cut off from every means of providing for itself. Rent and utilities are due. Groceries, including diapers, are needed, and there is no paycheck coming. It's impossible to fully describe the overwhelming anxiety and stress.

Your gift of any size keeps a roof over these kids' heads and food on their table while their family fights to stay together. Please give today, and share this with anyone who believes that every family deserves basic care, no matter where they were born.

We will provide periodic updates on how close we are to reaching our goal! This is a tangible, much-needed way to make a difference in this family's and in many other families' lives right now.

Please copy and paste URLs referenced in this issue into your web browser.

OCAN Has a New Website!

Thanks to OCAN subscriber and supporter Lance Gomez, we have a new website! Eventually our old and new website will merge, but for now check the new website at **https://ocanoregon.org**

Click the button on the new website under Our Mission titled **Read How OCAN Began** to learn more about our history and how OCAN came to be. You can also access the new website by scanning the QR code.

Volunteer Spotlight – Randy Jeremiah

Wendy Friedman

Last spring, Randy Jeremiah walked up to the OCAN table at a fundraiser organized by Indivisible. With a big smile he shared news of his recent retirement and desire to do more volunteer work. He carried our flyer home and completed our volunteer application form. For the question regarding what skills and abilities he has, Randy wrote "Intermediate level of Spanish, 30 years of handyman skills, extensive travel including Central America."



We were off and running! OCAN volunteer coordinators were able to plug Randy into assisting a homeowner who needed a guide in getting her house ready to rent. (The homeowner rents her home to immigrant community members and supports OCAN.) Randy toured the home with the homeowner, met with contractors, and provided invaluable advice and assistance on necessary updates.

Next, Randy pivoted to several smaller projects. When OCAN offered to buy a refrigerator and a washer/dryer for one of our families, Randy researched the best deals for new and used appliances and then transported and delivered the items. Recently he helped to winterize a fifth wheel trailer that is home to one family. Not having previous knowledge about this task, Randy attended a workshop and then completed the work.

Soon, Randy will be off to Guatemala to complete more volunteer work. This is his fourth year volunteering with Cascade Medical Team. He works in the mountains where indigenous Maya population live and helps them with their health and safety by installing stoves that use a fraction of the wood that open fires use.

OCAN is so grateful to Randy and to all our volunteers. We are a 100% volunteer organization and understand that each of you contributes in unique ways. Just by reading our newsletter and our emails, you are educating yourself about our neighbors and community members who are facing extreme hardships.

OCAN's Culturally Relevant Food Pantry

Ginger Gouveia

A little background on OCAN's food pantry

Our first food deliveries to six families took place in June. We are now delivering to 18 families every two weeks, a total of 56 adults and children.

Why is OCAN's food pantry important?

- It's true that OCAN families have access to other food pantries in the area, but our food baskets include masa, rice, black beans, queso, chicken, milk, eggs, and potatoes, along with other culturally appropriate foods that are often not available at other food pantries. And with the help of generous donors with gardens, deliveries sometimes contain fresh fruits and vegetables, including tomatoes, peppers, grapes, apples, pears, and even special Oaxacan squash! These foods are appreciated by the families because they are familiar foods that they like and know how to cook and use.





- Delivering to their houses helps keep families safe. Some food pantries involve waiting in lines that make them feel vulnerable to potential ICE apprehension.
- Food is expensive! Many OCAN families were already struggling, and then work hours were cut or a business where they worked closed due to ICE, making challenging times even worse. Working with a lawyer, which almost every family has to do, results in very costly expenses—as well as missed work due to legal appointments. Several families have told us that these food deliveries arrive "just in time."

How does the program work?

Eleven volunteers pick up the food at the pantry and deliver to the families every other Thursday at agreed-upon times. The volunteer signs in. Bags of non-refrigerated items are already ready with each family's name on them. Bags with the refrigerated items are filled upon arrival. The same volunteer usually delivers to the same family or families, which strengthens relationships and creates opportunities for cultural exchange.

Do volunteers need to speak Spanish?

Volunteers do not need to speak Spanish! The families are accustomed to using the Google Translate app on their phones—in fact, the majority of our volunteers speak little or no Spanish and can still communicate. And sometimes the relationship

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formed creates an unplanned opportunity! One family member and volunteer have started to include a short sit-down conversation time in Spanish on delivery days to give the volunteer an opportunity to practice her Spanish.

This program exists because of the generosity and help of many people!
Many thanks to:

- Oregon Community Foundation for a $5000 start-up grant.
- Social Justice Advocates team at Central Presbyterian Church. They purchase large quantities of items like masa and rice and repackage them into family size portions.
- Community members who donated fresh fruits and vegetables, and even a refrigerator!
- Our volunteers: Some do the shopping, others package and label the food for each family, and others deliver the food to families every other week.

We could use your help!

If you would like to learn more and perhaps help out, either on a regular basis or as needed, please contact Ginger at: **beachwalker85@pm.me**. It would be especially great to have a few more volunteers who could act as back-ups and deliver food when a regular volunteer is out of town.

Thank You, Xicha Brewing!

Xicha Brewing held a fundraiser for OCAN on September 30. It was so much fun! It gave everyone a chance to chat with friends, eat some great food, and have some drinks.



We sold raffle tickets for two baskets and played Loteria, a hilarious Mexican board game similar to BINGO. Loteria cards cost $5 and all funds raised from the game went to OCAN.

Xicha gave us a check for $295, and through the raffle and donations at the door we raised an additional $350.

Please thank Xicha the next time you are there!
Xicha Brewing, 747 E. 32nd Ave., Eugene.

How You Can Help!

The community members we are helping continue to be scared that ICE will detain them or their family or friends. Some have lost a breadwinner through ICE. Some have lost a job or had their hours cut since Latino businesses are getting less business due to their customers being afraid to go out.

We need your help in the following ways:

- Accompany asylees to their scheduled ICE appointments in Eugene and in Portland. We also need volunteers to drive asylees to their appointments. We like to have volunteers attend a workshop on how to accompany asylees. If you are interested, please contact us and we can put you on a waiting list for the training.
- Help in picking up food boxes, groceries, and prescriptions, or help in transporting and accompanying people picking up these items.
- Help in transporting and supporting people going to medical appointments.
- Make part of the meal for a twice-monthly support group for asylees.
- Transport people to their jobs due to fear of being taken by ICE on their way to or from work.

We also need:

- Donations of household products (e.g., toilet paper, paper towels, toiletries, cleaning products)
- Affordable housing
- Donations for bus passes
- Bike locks and helmets
- Phones
- Volunteers who can speak Spanish (there are many tasks that can be done if you don't speak Spanish)
- Volunteers who can provide occasional care to child asylees (parents would be nearby)

Tell your friends and neighbors about OCAN! There are many ways to resist the current regime: Encourage them to subscribe to our newsletter, donate, sign up to volunteer, and support our fundraisers by going to: **https://ocanoregon.org**.

ICE Activity in Our Area

Sue Barnhart

Surely it can't happen here! Except it does.

We've seen increased ICE activity around the state, with more immigrants taken by ICE in the past month than in other months this year. We expect this trend to continue through November and December as ICE tries to meet their goals for the year. ICE vehicles are routinely seen circling various neighborhoods in Eugene, Bethel, Springfield, Creswell, and Cottage Grove. ICE also continues to nab people as they leave traffic court.

Some people OCAN knows were recently taken by ICE. Luckily, one man was released in the past few days, although he will need to go to an appointment soon at the ICE office in Eugene. It is unknown what will happen at that appointment.

Normally, people who come here seeking asylum have a credible fear interview early on in the long immigration process. At one time this occurred when people initially crossed the border. Lately however, some refugees and asylum seekers nationwide who came to this country while Biden was still in office have had to endure a second credible fear interview. It requires the person to relive every horrific detail of their traumas a second time, and if their memory falters in even the slightest detail from what they said years ago, it may be construed as lying. At least one person locally was detained after his most recent interview.

Some people get a letter saying they must schedule this interview within ten days, but by the time they get the letter, ten days may already have passed. Other people don't receive a letter and instead are notified through a website. That means our neighbors must now monitor this website on top of everything else they are doing.

Our community members continue to live in fear and continue to need our support. One way to help is to get on Signal and join the Melt Ice Lane County Emergency Response System (MILCERS) chat.

If you see an ICE vehicle and if it is safe to do so, stop and observe from a distance.

1. Remember this acronym: **C L E A R**.
   C - **Count** the vehicles and agents
   L - Get the **Location**
   E - Report the type of **Equipment** (e.g., vehicles, guns, tasers, etc.)
   A - **Activity**: What are they doing?
   R - **Report** the time, and use your phone to **Record**

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2. Call **1-888-622-1510**, Portland Immigration Rights Coalition Hotline (PIRC)

3. If you can do so safely, ask the immigration agents:
   - *Which agency are you with?*
   - *Are you conducting immigration enforcement?*
   - *Do you have a judicial warrant, and if so, can I see it?*
   - *Are you detaining someone, and if so, on what grounds?*
   - *What are your names and badge numbers?*

I encourage anyone interested to take a training offered by PIRC when it is next offered. Once you are on Signal, feel free to email me at **suebarnhart@proton.me** if you need help finding the MILCERS Signal chat or if you would like training in watching ICE agents going in and out of the Federal building to monitor whether they have kidnapped someone or are about to do so.

Big Thanks to the Oregon Country Fair!

The Oregon Country Fair Jill Heinman Fund just gave OCAN $8,329! Jill Heinman served as attorney for the Oregon Country Fair. She cared deeply about helping people, the environment, and the arts. She died tragically in childbirth years ago, and a fund was set up in her name.

Each year fair members vote whether the grants should be awarded to nonprofits that help with basic needs, with the environment, or with the arts. In 2025 and again in 2026 OCF voted to focus on basic needs. Tod Schneider wrote a grant for OCAN that was accepted!

This grant from OCF arrived at a good time. For the past six months OCAN received an average of three requests per month for housing assistance ranging from $500 to $2000. A family's small trailer started to leak and the shower base broke, so we purchased a newer trailer and sealed the roof. We pay annual asylum fees of $105 when they come due. We purchased a washer/dryer set for a family that moved into a new low-income apartment. We pay utility bills and phone bills to keep the lights on and communication possible. When needed, we pay $50 application fees required with many rental applications for every family member over 18 years old.

Thank you Oregon Country Fair, and thank you Tod Schneider!

OCAN Depends on Financial Contributions to Help Asylees in Our Area!

Since OCAN formed in the fall of 2018, we have helped more than 200 asylee adults and children and are now actively assisting about 60 adults and children. We recently had referrals from LCC, Bethel School District, and other community organizations. The need is great to help with rent, utilities, and bonds to get people out of detention centers.

Here is how your donation can help:

$250 - Helps fund an immigration attorney consultation

$100 - Helps with rent assistance for a week

$50 - Helps with a monthly bus pass

$35 - Helps pay for cell phone service for a month

Grassroots Connect serves as our nonprofit umbrella and fiscal sponsor. Your donation to OCAN is now fully tax deductible. Grassroots Connect does not take any money for this service, so if you donate by check, 100% of your donation will go to help asylees. If you donate online, there is a 5% fee from Stripe.

To donate by check:

1. Write a check payable to OCAN.
2. Indicate on the memo line if your donation is for a specific OCAN project such as “monthly bus passes” or “help with legal fees.”
3. Mail to OCAN, P.O. Box 5961, Eugene, OR 97405.

To donate to OCAN online:

1. Go to the OCAN page on the Grassroots Connect. website: **https://ocanoregon.org**
2. Scroll down and click on DONATE.
3. Your donation will go toward supporting our community members with rent assistance, help with legal fees, and other needs.